1969 GTO Judge Release Timeline from Pontiac Documents

Each entry quotes the document exactly. None of these documents names a VIN, dealer order number or dealer for a specific car.

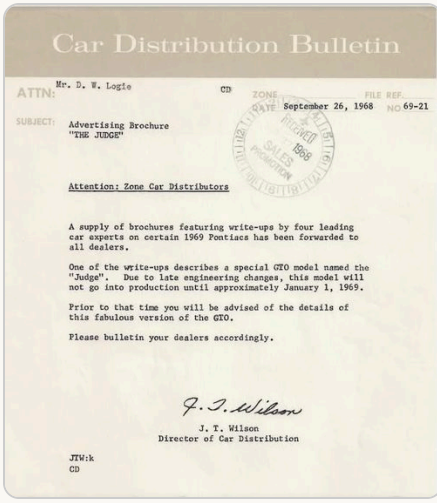
Date	Document and quote	Image

Sep 26, 1968

Car Distribution Bulletin 69-21, J. T. Wilson, Director of Car Distribution

“a special GTO model named the “Judge”. Due to late engineering changes, this model will not go into production until approximately January 1, 1969.”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



Car Distribution Bulletin

ATTN: Mr. D. W. Logie CD ZONE FILE REF.

DATE: September 26, 1968 No. 69-21

SUBJECT: Advertising Brochure "THE JUDGE"

Attention: Zone Car Distributors

A supply of brochures featuring write-ups by four leading car experts on certain 1969 Pontiacs has been forwarded to all dealers.

One of the write-ups describes a special GTO model named the "Judge". Due to late engineering changes, this model will not go into production until approximately January 1, 1969.

Prior to that time you will be advised of the details of this fabulous version of the GTO.

Please bulletin your dealers accordingly.

J. T. Wilson

J. T. Wilson
Director of Car Distribution

JTW:k
CD

Oct 31, 1968

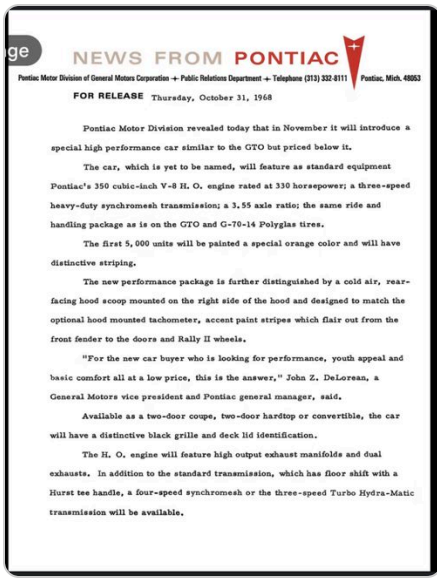
PMD Public Relations release

“The first 5,000 units will be painted a special orange color and will have distinctive striping.” (car “yet to be named,” 350 H.O. engine)

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**

That it describes a planned car, not the Judge as announced:

Corroborated interpretation



NEWS FROM PONTIAC

Pontiac Motor Division of General Motors Corporation + Public Relations Department + Telephone (313) 332-8111 Pontiac, Mich. 48053

FOR RELEASE Thursday, October 31, 1968

Pontiac Motor Division revealed today that in November it will introduce a special high performance car similar to the GTO but priced below it.

The car, which is yet to be named, will feature as standard equipment Pontiac's 350 cubic-inch V-8 H. O. engine rated at 330 horsepower; a three-speed heavy-duty synchromesh transmission; a 3.55 axle ratio; the same ride and handling package as is on the GTO and G-70-14 Polyglas tires.

The first 5,000 units will be painted a special orange color and will have distinctive striping.

The new performance package is further distinguished by a cold air, rear-facing hood scoop mounted on the right side of the hood and designed to match the optional hood mounted tachometer, accent paint stripes which flair out from the front fender to the doors and Rally II wheels.

"For the new car buyer who is looking for performance, youth appeal and basic comfort all at a low price, this is the answer," John Z. DeLorean, a General Motors vice president and Pontiac general manager, said.

Available as a two-door coupe, two-door hardtop or convertible, the car will have a distinctive black grille and deck lid identification.

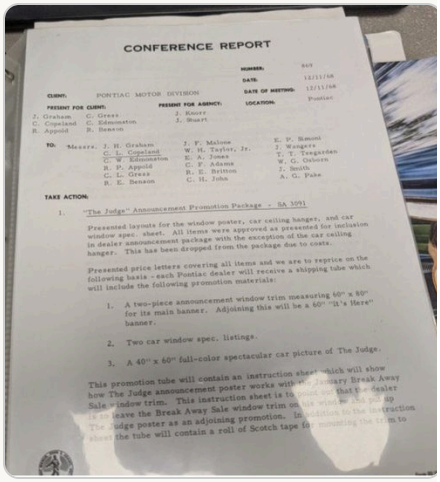
The H. O. engine will feature high output exhaust manifolds and dual exhausts. In addition to the standard transmission, which has floor shift with a Hurst tee handle, a four-speed synchromesh or the three-speed Turbo Hydra-Matic transmission will be available.

Dec 11, 1968

Agency Conference Report No. 869 (client: Pontiac Motor Division)

“‘The Judge’ Announcement Promotion Package - SA 3091”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



CONFERENCE REPORT

CLIENT: PONTIAC MOTOR DIVISION

TAKE ACTION:

1. "The Judge" Announcement Promotion Package - SA 3091

Presented layouts for the window poster, car ceiling hanger, and car window spec. sheet. All items were approved as presented for inclusion in dealer announcement package with the exception of the car ceiling hanger. This has been dropped from the package due to costs.

Presented price letters covering all items and we are to reprice on the following basis - each Pontiac dealer will receive a shipping tube which will include the following promotion materials:

1. A two-piece announcement window trim measuring 60" x 80" for its main banner. Adjoining this will be a 60" "It's Here" banner.
2. Two car window spec. listings.
3. A 40" x 60" full-color spectacular car picture of The Judge.

This promotion tube will contain an instruction sheet which will show how The Judge announcement poster works with the ...ary Break Away Sale window trim. This instruction sheet is to ... that the dealer is to leave the Break Away Sale window trim on ... The Judge poster as an adjoining promotion. In addition to the instruction sheet the tube will contain a roll of Scotch tape for ...

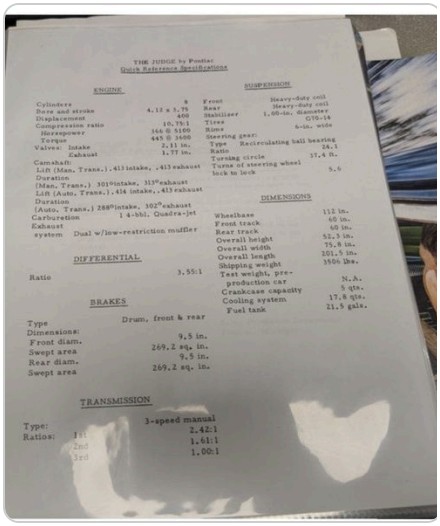
Undated

“THE JUDGE by Pontiac Quick Reference Specifications” (filed with Conf. Report 869)

“Test weight, pre-production car N.A.”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**

Date: **Unresolved**



THE JUDGE by Pontiac
Quick Reference Specifications

ENGINE

Cylinders	8
Bore and stroke	4.12 x 3.75
Displacement	400
Compression ratio	10.75:1
Horsepower	366 @ 5100
Torque	445 @ 3600
Valves: Intake	2.11 in.
Exhaust	1.77 in.
Camshaft:	
Lift (Man. Trans.)	.413 intake, .413 exhaust
Duration	
(Man. Trans.)	301° intake, 313° exhaust
Lift (Auto. Trans.)	.414 intake, .413 exhaust
Duration	
(Auto. Trans.)	288° intake, 302° exhaust
Carburetion	1 4-bbl. Quadra-jet
Exhaust system	Dual w/low-restriction muffler

DIFFERENTIAL

Ratio	3.55:1

BRAKES

Type	Drum, front & rear
Dimensions:	
Front diam.	9.5 in.
Swept area	269.2 sq. in.
Rear diam.	9.5 in.
Swept area	269.2 sq. in.

TRANSMISSION

Type:	3-speed manual
Ratios: 1st	2.42:1
2nd	1.61:1
3rd	1.00:1

SUSPENSION

Front	Heavy-duty coil
Rear	Heavy-duty coil
Stabilizer	1.00-in. diameter
Tires	G70-14
Rims	6-in. wide
Steering gear:	
Type	Recirculating ball bearing
Ratio	24.1
Turning circle	37.4 ft.
Turns of steering wheel lock to lock	5.6

DIMENSIONS

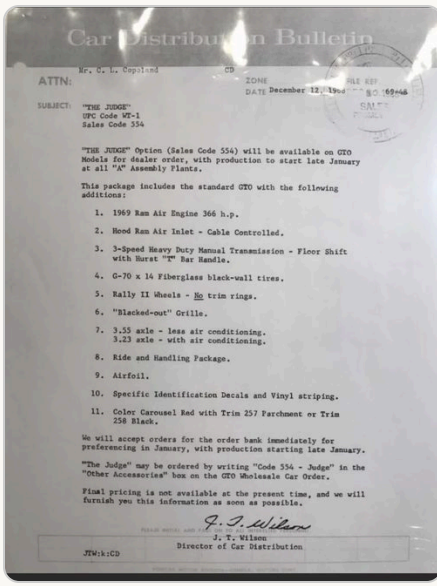
Wheelbase	112 in.
Front track	60 in.
Rear track	60 in.
Overall height	52.3 in.
Overall width	75.8 in.
Overall length	201.5 in.
Shipping weight	3500 lbs.
Test weight, pre-production car	N.A.
Crankcase capacity	5 qts.
Cooling system	17.8 qts.
Fuel tank	21.5 gals.

Dec 12, 1968

Car Distribution Bulletin 69-48, J. T. Wilson

“production to start late January at all ‘A’ Assembly Plants”; “Color Carousel Red with Trim 257 Parchment or Trim 258 Black.”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



Car Distribution Bulletin

ATTN: Mr. C. L. Copeland CD

ZONE DATE December 12, 1968

SUBJECT: "THE JUDGE"
UPC Code WT-1
Sales Code 334

"THE JUDGE" Option (Sales Code 554) will be available on GTO Models for dealer order, with production to start late January at all "A" Assembly Plants.

This package includes the standard GTO with the following additions:

1. 1969 Ram Air Engine 366 h.p.
2. Hood Ram Air Inlet - Cable Controlled.
3. 3-Speed Heavy Duty Manual Transmission - Floor Shift with Burnt "T" Bar Handle.
4. G-70 x 14 Fiberglass black-wall tires.
5. Rally II Wheels - No trim rings.
6. "Blacked-out" Grille.
7. 3.55 axle - less air conditioning.
   3.23 axle - with air conditioning.
8. Ride and Handling Package.
9. Airfoil.
10. Specific Identification Decals and Vinyl striping.
11. Color Carousel Red with Trim 257 Parchment or Trim 258 Black.

We will accept orders for the order bank immediately for preferencing in January, with production starting late January.

"The Judge" may be ordered by writing "Code 554 - Judge" in the "Other Accessories" box on the GTO Wholesale Car Order.

Final pricing is not available at the present time, and we will furnish you this information as soon as possible.

J. T. Wilson
Director of Car Distribution

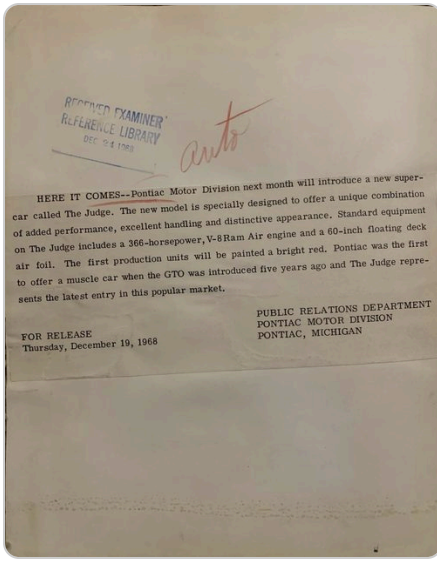
JTW:k:CD

Dec 19, 1968

PMD release (Examiner reference library copy, stamped Dec 24, 1968)

“The first production units will be painted a bright red.”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



RECEIVED EXAMINER REFERENCE LIBRARY DEC 24 1968

HERE IT COMES--Pontiac Motor Division next month will introduce a new super-car called The Judge. The new model is specially designed to offer a unique combination of added performance, excellent handling and distinctive appearance. Standard equipment on The Judge includes a 366-horsepower, V-8 Ram Air engine and a 60-inch floating deck air foil. The first production units will be painted a bright red. Pontiac was the first to offer a muscle car when the GTO was introduced five years ago and The Judge represents the latest entry in this popular market.

FOR RELEASE
Thursday, December 19, 1968

PUBLIC RELATIONS DEPARTMENT
PONTIAC MOTOR DIVISION
PONTIAC, MICHIGAN

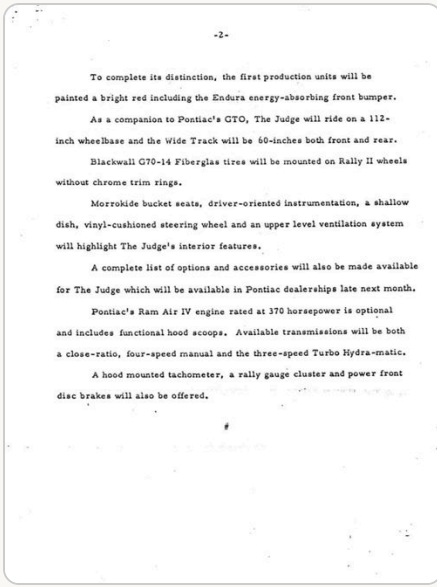
Undated

PMD release, page 2 only

"the first production units will be painted a bright red including the Endura energy-absorbing front bumper."

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**

Date: **Unresolved**



-2-

To complete its distinction, the first production units will be painted a bright red including the Endura energy-absorbing front bumper.

As a companion to Pontiac's GTO, The Judge will ride on a 112-inch wheelbase and the Wide Track will be 60-inches both front and rear.

Blackwall G70-14 Fiberglas tires will be mounted on Rally II wheels without chrome trim rings.

Morrokide bucket seats, driver-oriented instrumentation, a shallow dish, vinyl-cushioned steering wheel and an upper level ventilation system will highlight The Judge's interior features.

A complete list of options and accessories will also be made available for The Judge which will be available in Pontiac dealerships late next month.

Pontiac's Ram Air IV engine rated at 370 horsepower is optional and includes functional hood scoops. Available transmissions will be both a close-ratio, four-speed manual and the three-speed Turbo Hydra-matic.

A hood mounted tachometer, a rally gauge cluster and power front disc brakes will also be offered.

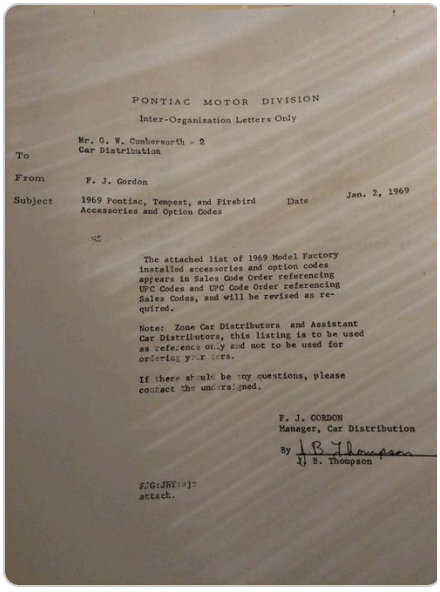
Jan 2, 1969

F. J. Gordon letter on accessories and option codes; page "Revisions to Oct. 29th Listing"

"554-WT1 NEW OPTION TEMPEST"

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**

That this page is the letter's attachment rests on owner identification.



PONTIAC MOTOR DIVISION

Inter-Organization Letters Only

To Mr. G. W. Cumberworth - 2
Car Distribution

From F. J. Gordon

Subject 1969 Pontiac, Tempest, and Firebird Accessories and Option Codes

Date Jan. 2, 1969

The attached list of 1969 Model Factory installed accessories and option codes appears in Sales Code Order referencing UPC Codes and UPC Code Order referencing Sales Codes, and will be revised as required.

Note: Zone Car Distributors and Assistant Car Distributors, this listing is to be used as reference only and not to be used for ordering your cars.

If there should be any questions, please contact the undersigned.

F. J. GORDON
Manager, Car Distribution

By J. B. Thompson
J. B. Thompson

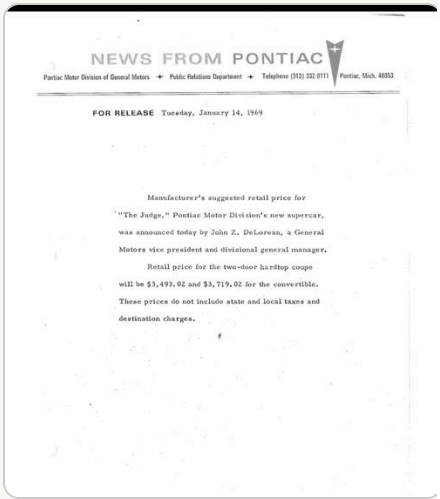
FJG:JBT:sj
attach.

Jan 14, 1969

NEWS FROM PONTIAC price release

"$3,493.02 and $3,719.02 for the convertible."

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



NEWS FROM PONTIAC

Pontiac Motor Division of General Motors + Public Relations Department + Telephone (313) 332-8111 Pontiac, Mich. 48053

FOR RELEASE Tuesday, January 14, 1969

Manufacturer's suggested retail price for "The Judge," Pontiac Motor Division's new supercar, was announced today by John Z. DeLorean, a General Motors vice president and divisional general manager.

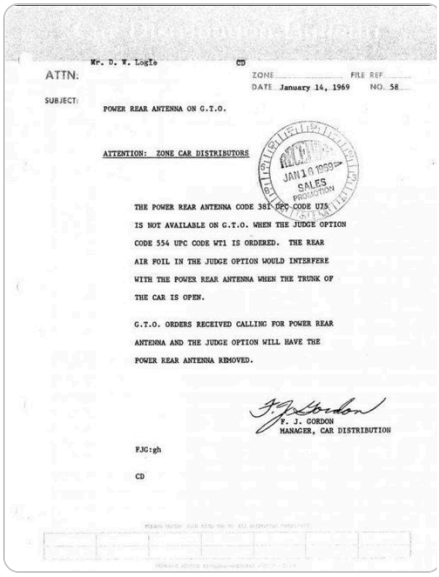
Retail price for the two-door hardtop coupe will be $3,493.02 and $3,719.02 for the convertible. These prices do not include state and local taxes and destination charges.

Jan 14, 1969

Car Distribution Bulletin No. 58, F. J. Gordon (rear antenna)

“NOT AVAILABLE ON G.T.O. WHEN THE JUDGE OPTION CODE 554 UPC CODE WT1 IS ORDERED.”

Tier 2 · **Documented fact**



ATTN: Mr. D. W. Logie CD

ZONE FILE REF.

DATE January 14, 1969 NO. 58

SUBJECT: POWER REAR ANTENNA ON G.T.O.

ATTENTION: ZONE CAR DISTRIBUTORS

JAN 10 1969 SALES PROMOTION

THE POWER REAR ANTENNA CODE 383 (OR) CODE U28 IS NOT AVAILABLE ON G.T.O. WHEN THE JUDGE OPTION CODE 554 UPC CODE WT1 IS ORDERED. THE REAR AIR FOIL IN THE JUDGE OPTION WOULD INTERFERE WITH THE POWER REAR ANTENNA WHEN THE TRUNK OF THE CAR IS OPEN.

G.T.O. ORDERS RECEIVED CALLING FOR POWER REAR ANTENNA AND THE JUDGE OPTION WILL HAVE THE POWER REAR ANTENNA REMOVED.

F. J. Gordon

F. J. GORDON
MANAGER, CAR DISTRIBUTION

FJG:gh

CD

Late Jan 1969 (printed Feb 2, 1969)

Boston Herald Traveler, “Pontiac ‘Judge’ is Here,” John Rooney

“Twenty five of the new Carousel Red, hardtop coupes were assigned to dealers to be driven to their dealerships.”

Tier 3 · **Documented fact**

What the article reports; it names no VIN.



BOSTON HERALD TRAVELER, FEBRUARY 2, 1969

Pontiac 'Judge' is Here

By JOHN ROONEY

Meet the Judge, exclaimed Thomas L. King, general sales manager of Pontiac Motor Division, as he unveiled the first of Pontiac's new super car, "The Judge" to Pontiac dealers of the Boston zone, last week at the General Motors Training Center in Dedham.

Joseph C. Cheesbrough, Boston zone manager of Pontiac, scored a 10 strike, in having King come to Boston to address the dealer group, as King is well known to the Boston zone dealers.

Twenty five of the new Carousel Red, hardtop coupes were assigned to dealers to be driven to their dealerships.

COMMENTING on "The Judge," King reported the car is a companion to Pontiac's GTO, and will ride on a 112-inch wheelbase and the Wide Track is 60-inches both front and rear.

There are two models in the line, a hardtop coupe and convertible. The front is distinguished by a black grille, exposed headlamps

PONTIAC GENERAL SALES MANAGER Thomas L. King (left) and Boston zone manager Joseph C. Cheesbrough, attend dealer drive-away of the new Pontiac, named "The Judge" at GM Training Center, Dedham.

Feb 17, 1969

The Pontiac Press (Pontiac, Mich.), page C-6: retail ad

“The Judge... Now presiding at Pontiac Retail Store, 65 University Drive and E. Wide Track.” The ad lists a 366-hp 400 Ram Air V-8, floor-mounted 3-speed, 60-inch spoiler, mag-type wheels and “blue-red-yellow striping.”



Call Now — 335-9293
Ask for Ed Marska

THE JUDGE

A SPECIAL GTO BY PONTIAC

Now presiding at
Pontiac Retail Store

65 University Drive and E. Wide Track

Open Monday and Thursday 8:30-9, Tues., Wed., and Fri. 'til 6, Sat. 'til 5

Make tracks, performance lovers. The balance of power has just been upset. Again. By Pontiac. Meet the newest appointment. The Judge. A very special GTO.

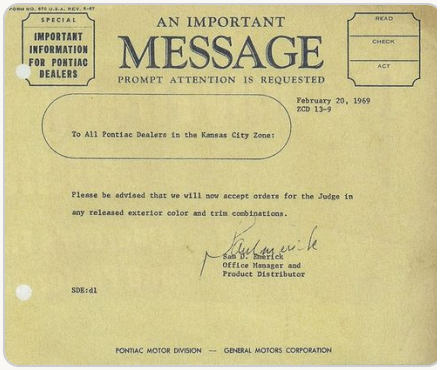
The Judge. With a standard 366-hp, 400-cube Ram Air V-8. The Judge. With a standard all-synchro, floor-mounted 3-speed. The Judge. With a standard 60-inch spoiler for all the world to see. The Judge. With standard mag-type wheels. And blue-red-yellow striping.

Make a date for a session, because The Judge will rule. In your favor, baby. In your favor.

Tier 3 · **Documented fact**
(Tier 3: period newspaper)

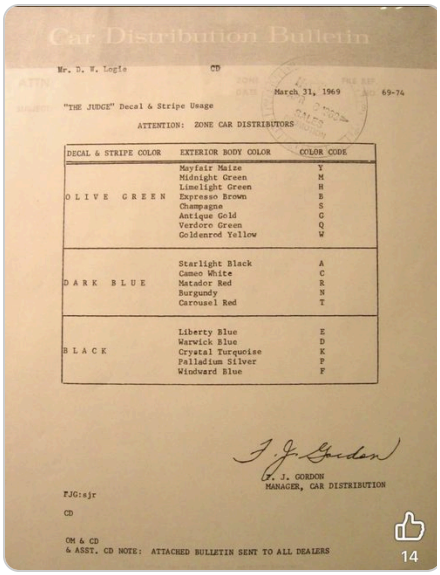
Feb 20, 1969

Kansas City Zone dealer message ZCD 13-9, Sam D. Emerick
“we will now accept orders for the Judge in any released exterior color and trim combinations.”
Tier 2 · **Documented fact**


SPECIAL
IMPORTANT INFORMATION FOR PONTIAC DEALERS
AN IMPORTANT
MESSAGE
PROMPT ATTENTION IS REQUESTED
READ
CHECK
ACT
February 20, 1969
ZCD 13-9
To All Pontiac Dealers in the Kansas City Zone:
Please be advised that we will now accept orders for the Judge in any released exterior color and trim combinations.
Sam D. Emerick
Office Manager and Product Distributor
SDE:dl
PONTIAC MOTOR DIVISION — GENERAL MOTORS CORPORATION

Mar 31, 1969

Car Distribution Bulletin 69-74, F. J. Gordon
“‘THE JUDGE’ Decal & Stripe Usage”
Tier 2 · **Documented fact**

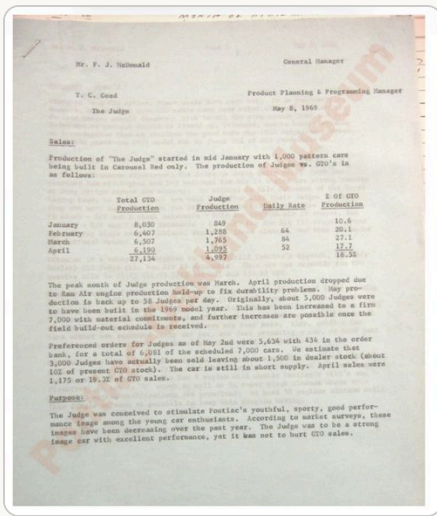

Car Distribution Bulletin
Mr. D. W. Logie CD
March 31, 1969 69-74
"THE JUDGE" Decal & Stripe Usage
ATTENTION: ZONE CAR DISTRIBUTORS

DECAL & STRIPE COLOR	EXTERIOR BODY COLOR	COLOR CODE
OLIVE GREEN	Mayfair Maize	Y
	Midnight Green	M
	Limelight Green	H
	Expresso Brown	B
	Champagne	S
	Antique Gold	G
	Verdoro Green	Q
	Goldenrod Yellow	W
DARK BLUE	Starlight Black	A
	Cameo White	C
	Matador Red	R
	Burgundy	N
	Carousel Red	T
BLACK	Liberty Blue	E
	Warwick Blue	D
	Crystal Turquoise	K
	Palladium Silver	F
	Windward Blue	F

F. J. Gordon
F. J. GORDON
MANAGER, CAR DISTRIBUTION
FJG:sjr
CD
ON & CD
& ASST. CD NOTE: ATTACHED BULLETIN SENT TO ALL DEALERS
14

May 8, 1969

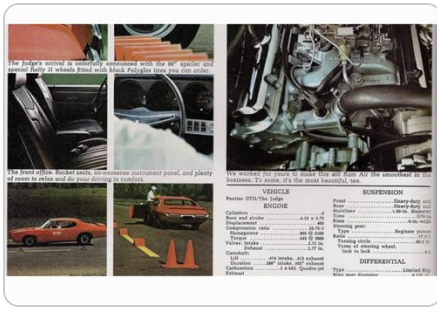
Memo, T. C. Goad to F. J. McDonald, “The Judge” (page 1)
“started in mid January with 1,000 pattern cars being built in Carousel Red only”
Tier 2 · **Documented fact**


Mr. F. J. McDonald General Manager
T. C. Goad Product Planning & Programming Manager
The Judge May 8, 1969
Sales:
Production of "The Judge" started in mid January with 1,000 pattern cars being built in Carousel Red only. The production of Judges vs. GTO's is as follows:

	Total GTO Production	Judge Production	Daily Rate	% of GTO Production
January	8,030	849		10.6
February	6,407	1,255	64	20.1
March	6,307	1,705	84	27.1
April	6,190	1,025	52	17.5
	27,134	4,933		18.3±

The peak month of Judge production was March. April production dropped due to Ram Air engine production hold-up to fix durability problems. May production is back up to 56 Judges per day. Originally, about 5,000 Judges were to have been built in the 1969 model year. This has been increased to a firm 7,000 with material commitments, and further increases are possible once the field build-out schedule is received.
Preferenced orders for Judges as of May 2nd were 5,634 with 434 in the order bank, for a total of 6,051 of the scheduled 7,000 cars. We estimate that 3,000 Judges have actually been sold leaving about 1,560 in dealer stock (about 10% of present GTO stock). The car is still in short supply. April sales were 1,175 or 19.2% of GTO sales.
Purpose:
The Judge was conceived to stimulate Pontiac's youthful, sporty, good performance image among the young car enthusiasts. According to market surveys, these images have been decreasing over the past year. The Judge was to be a strong image car with excellent performance, yet it was not to hurt GTO sales.

Undated (1969 model year)	**Judge sales brochure spread** Lists the 400 Ram Air engine at 366 horsepower at 5100 rpm (paraphrase). Tier 2 · **Documented fact** Date: **Unresolved**



Not on file: page 1 of the undated release; page 2 of the Goad memo.

AI assistance was used to compile and format this site. Every claim was drawn from Al Diaz's research files and is labeled under his Research Standards & Evidence Policy v1.0. Corrections are welcome and will be dated.

Last updated October 19, 2026. Research by Al Diaz. Labels: **Documented fact** **Corroborated interpretation** **Hypothesis** **Unresolved**

YouTube **Facebook**